

AMOS WS26/27 - NIM - Automated Thematic Analysis

PROJECT RETROSPECTIVE

What went well?

In general, we had a lot of fun working on this project all together. Working on a real industry project was highly motivating. Instead of solving isolated exercises, we could see how the product developed from the first commit into working software that is genuinely useful. The close exchange with the industry partner made the work feel relevant and gave us a realistic view of customer communication and product development.

The course also provided practical experience that is difficult to gain in a purely theoretical module. We learned how Scrum works in an actual team, including sprint planning, retrospectives, GitHub workflows, coordination and shared responsibility. Over time, the meetings and planning process became smoother and more professional, while the teams still had enough freedom to organize their work independently.

Pair programming, the industry and guest lectures, and the overall team collaboration were particularly valuable. Pairing helped with difficult tasks and made problem solving more efficient. The team atmosphere was positive, and the project showed how much can be achieved when the Scrum Master, POs, SDs and industry partner communicate openly and work toward the same goal.

What didn't go well?

At the beginning, the course organization and the different information sources were sometimes difficult to navigate. Important instructions were not always easy to find, and some procedures - such as the expected Git workflow, the happiness index pages and the repeated Demo Day presentations - was a bit complicated but we came into it real quick. The mandatory Wednesday block could also be difficult to combine with jobs or other commitments, but all team members agreed on taking the time necessary for the course.

The PO role was especially demanding at the start. It was not immediately clear how meetings should be run, how the application should be planned, or which documents were actually useful. More role-specific guidance would have reduced the initial uncertainty. In our case, planning documents often duplicated work that was already managed more effectively in GitHub Projects and therefore felt more like an additional chore than a useful planning tool.

Workload and motivation were not always evenly distributed among the SDs. This became problematic when issues or pull requests blocked follow-up work and the team had planned with more available development capacity. Recurring homework deliverables also tended to remain with the most active team members because ownership was not clearly assigned. Finally, some important contributions - for example setting up the NHR inference infrastructure - required substantial effort but were not well represented by commits or lines of code.

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